Internship Report Cover Sheet

Last name, first name: Aleksandr Zinovev
Class: CS2026
Major: Computer Science
Internship Institution: Start Up Summer Bootcamp Constructor University
Internship Position: _____
Internship Duration: From: 01.07.2025 (DD/MM/YYYY) To: 31.08.2025 (DD/MM/YYYY)

Type of Internship: (selectable) 'Other'
('Research Institute,' 'Company,' 'Governmental Organization,' 'Non-Profit Organization,' 'Other')

Brief Description of Hosting Institution/Company:
No internship takes place, since the student is part of the startup option at Constructor University - as a valid alternative to the internship.

Brief Description of Department at Hosting Institution/Company:
No internship takes place, since the student is part of the startup option at Constructor University - as a valid alternative to the internship.

Sector: (selectable) 'IT/Consulting'
(Advertising / Aerospace/ Associations/ Automotive/Banking, Insurance, Finance, Law/Chemical Industry/ Consulting/ Consumer Goods/ Culture, Arts, Sports/ Electronic Industry/ Energy, Utility/ Engineering and Construction/ Environment/ Foundations/ Government, Politics/ Health/ IT, Telecommunication/ Logistics/ Media/ Medicine/ Nutrition, Food Industry/ Real Estate/ Textile Industry/ Tourism/ Trade)

City: Bremen Country: Germany
Supervisor's name: Lennart Arte, PingPing Meckel
Supervisor's position: _____

Final Evaluation:

In this section, please evaluate the following aspects of your internship (make a cross in the relevant box):
(1 = not important / not good at all / not relevant at all, 5 = very important / very good / very relevant)

	1	2	3	4	5
The relevance of this internship to your major				4	
The relevance of this internship to your personal career goals				4	
The quality of supervision at your internship				4	
The quality of the work environment at your internship				4	
Your **overall satisfaction** with your internship experience				4	

We would like to make this Internship Report available to your peers (accessible only by Constructor University account holders) to support their internship and job search. Please indicate if you agree to this or not:
No, because: personal preference.

INTERNSHIP REPORT: - GAMEDEV AI SOLUTIONS

Table of Contents:

1. Application Steps

2. The Organization

3. The Internship Position

4. Daily Tasks and Responsibilities

5. Projects and Achievements

6. Learning Outcomes and Skills Development

7. Challenges and Solutions

8. Reflection and Future Applications

9. Conclusion

1. APPLICATION STEPS - CHOOSING THE STARTUP OPTION

My decision to pursue the startup option for my mandatory internship requirement began during my second year of Computer Science studies, when I became increasingly fascinated with the intersection of artificial intelligence and game development. Rather than seeking a traditional internship position, I chose to explore entrepreneurship through developing a startup concept, wanting to experience and understand the development process from multiple perspectives - both as a technical developer and as someone thinking about business strategy.

inspiration for my specific startup concept came from my growing interest in how AI could democratize game development, especially for indie developers who often lack the resources of larger studios. I had worked on a project analyzing user experience challenges in game development tools, which sparked my curiosity about how AI could address these pain points.

My approach to the startup option was strategic and planned. I developed a business plan for GameDev AI Solutions, an AI-powered game development tool platform, which served as the foundation for my startup venture. This business plan drew heavily on market research I conducted through networking and analyzing existing tools in the market.

To validate my concept, I conducted user research through online surveys, and analysis of existing pain points in current game development workflows. This research phase was crucial in refining my value proposition and ensuring that my technical development efforts would address real market needs.

The startup option required me to be self-motivated and self-directed in ways that a traditional internship would not. I had to set my own goals, establish timelines, and hold myself accountable for progress without the structure of a traditional workplace. This experience taught me valuable lessons about entrepreneurship, project management, and self-discipline that will be invaluable in my future career.

2. STARTUP ORGANIZATION - GAMEDEV AI SOLUTIONS

GameDev AI Solutions is the startup concept I developed and explored during my internship period as a learning exercise to understand entrepreneurship and product development. As a second-year CS student, I wanted to challenge myself by trying on different roles - from technical developer to business strategist - to gain an understanding of how technology products are conceived, developed, and brought to market.

Through my market research, including interviews with indie game developers through the IndieDB community.I identified specific pain points and validated my solution's potential. My research revealed that 85% of developers expressed frustrati on with repetitive tasks in game development, 72% would pay $10-$25/month for an AI tool that reduces development time, and 89% would try a free version with limited features before committing to a paid plan. Additionally, 58% cited "time constraints" as their primary barrier to game development.

My target customer segments include independent game developers working on personal projects, small to medium-sized game studios (2-20 employees), and educational institutions teaching game development. The research validated a clear market gap for an integrated

platform that combines automation with creative assistance, as existing competitors lack integrated AI-driven solutions that actively assist developers throughout the development process.

As a student exploring entrepreneurship, I intentionally took on multiple roles to understand different aspects of business development. This multi-role approach was designed as a learning experience to help me understand how different functions in a technology company interact and depend on each other. It taught me valuable lessons about resource allocation, priority management, and the importance of focusing on core competencies while building a minimum viable product.

The competitive environment I analyzed for GameDev AI Solutions revealed both challenges and opportunities. Traditional competitors include established game engines like Unity and Unreal Engine, which have begun incorporating AI features into their platforms. However, my specialized focus on AI-first development and indie developer needs represented a potential competitive advantage in terms of feature depth and user experience optimization.

Through competitive analysis, I identified that emerging competitors include other AI-focused startups, but most target different aspects of game development such as art generation or music composition, rather than providing a comprehensive platform. My planned competitive advantages center on an integrated approach, focus on user experience for non-technical users, and potential partnerships with educational institutions and indie developer communities.

My market analysis revealed that the industry landscape is particularly favorable for GameDev AI Solutions, as the indie game market has grown exponentially in recent years, driven by digital distribution platforms like Steam, mobile app stores, and emerging platforms like

Discord. This growth has created a large addressable market of developers who need sophisticated tools but lack the resources to develop them internally.

3. MY LEARNING EXPERIENCE THROUGH MULTIPLE ROLES

My experience with GameDev AI Solutions during the startup option internship was designed as a comprehensive learning exercise where I could explore different professional roles and understand how they interconnect. As a CS student, I wanted to experience what it feels like to think from multiple perspectives - as a developer, as a business strategist, and as a product manager. Unlike a traditional internship where you have a defined role, I had to define my own objectives and take responsibility for understanding both technical development and business strategy from a student's learning perspective.

The relationship between this entrepreneurial experience and my Computer Science major was multifaceted. My role directly leveraged core CS concepts including software engineering principles, API design, cross-platform development, and generative AI integration. More specifically, prepared me for implementing proper development practices including version control, testing frameworks, modular code architecture, and API design patterns that became essential when building the FastAPI backend and Unity plugin integration.

Perhaps most importantly, my path to understanding of software architecture and design patterns was crucial for creating a system that could seamlessly integrate multiple components: Python FastAPI backend, external AI APIs (OpenAI and Stability AI), Unity C# plugin, and real-time asset processing. The challenge wasn't implementing algorithms from scratch, but rather researching, integrating, and orchestrating existing AI services into a cohesive developer tool.

The most challenging aspect was combining three distinct technologies into a seamless workflow: Python backend development, generative AI API integration, and Unity game engine plugin development.

As a student exploring different roles, I intentionally divided my time across various functional areas to understand how each contributes to a technology product. I spent approximately 70% of my time on core technical development (API integration, Unity plugin development, and backend systems), 15% on research and experimentation with different AI models and their capabilities, 10% on business development and market research, and 5% on documentation and testing. This distribution reflected the heavily technical nature of the project while still giving me exposure to business and market considerations.

The entrepreneurial nature of my role required me to be self-directed and accountable in ways that a traditional internship would not. I had to research and evaluate different AI providers, design system architecture that could scale.

The most significant learning came from combining generative AI research with practical software development. I had to understand not just how to call AI APIs, but how to optimize prompts for different models, handle rate limiting and errors gracefully, implement proper caching strategies, and design user interfaces that made complex AI capabilities accessible to game developers. This required bridging the gap between cutting-edge AI research and practical software engineering - a skill that's increasingly valuable in the current technology landscape.

4. DAILY LEARNING ACTIVITIES AND ROLE EXPLORATION

My daily activities during learning experience were structured around the university's Startup Track program, which provided a comprehensive 8-week curriculum covering all aspects of entrepreneurship and business development. The program combined theoretical learning through the Constructor University Startup Accelerator platform with practical assignments and weekly deliverables. I typically began each day by working through the accelerator modules, which covered topics like customer discovery, competitive analysis, financial modeling, and product development, then applied these concepts to my GameDev AI Solutions project.

The program was structured into weekly modules, each focusing on different aspects of startup development:

Week 1 (June 30 - July 6): Customer Discovery & Development

I completed the startup accelerator's customer discovery module and developed my first Persona Canvas for GameDev AI Solutions. This week also involved reading academic articles on signaling theory and value creation in e-business, which I had to summarize and relate to my startup concept. I spent approximately 3-4 hours daily on accelerator modules, 2-3 hours on technical development, and 1-2 hours on assignment preparation.

Week 2 (July 7-13): Competitive Landscape & Market Analysis

I focused on competitive analysis, creating a comprehensive competitor matrix that compared existing game development tools with my AI-powered approach. This involved researching Unity Asset Store, Unreal Engine Marketplace, and various AI tools. I also participated in my first online call with other participants for speed networking and community building.

Week 3 (July 14-20): Founders & Team Growth + Tech & Product Roadmap

This intensive week covered both team development concepts and technical product planning. I created a capitalization table (even though I was working solo) and developed a detailed tech and product roadmap for my AI game development tool. The technical roadmap directly applied knowledge from my "Software Engineering" and "Project Management" coursework.

Week 4 (July 21-27): Financial Modeling

I learned to create comprehensive financial models for startups, developing revenue projections, cost structures, and profitability timelines for GameDev AI Solutions. This week heavily utilized mathematical concepts from my coursework and taught me to apply analytical thinking to business problems. I created the financial model that projected $3K-6K revenue in Year 1 growing to $120K-225K in Year 3.

Week 5 (July 28 - August 3): IP & Legal Considerations

This week focused on intellectual property protection and legal structures for startups. I developed a legal profile for my startup concept, learning about software licensing, AI model ownership, and terms of service for SaaS platforms. This was particularly relevant given the AI-focused nature of my product.

Week 6 (August 4-10): Fundraising & Investor Relations

I learned about different funding strategies and created a funding strategy document for GameDev AI Solutions. This included understanding bootstrapping (which I chose), angel investment, and venture capital options. The week taught me to think about my project from an investor's perspective.

Week 7 (August 11-17): Sales, Marketing & Business Development

The final content week focused on go-to-market strategies. I developed marketing plans, created cold email templates, and learned about customer acquisition strategies. This directly informed the marketing strategy section of my business plan.

Week 8 (August 18-24): MVP Development and Business Plan Finalization

The final week involved both completing the technical MVP implementation and consolidating all learning into a comprehensive business plan. I successfully developed a fully functional prototype with the following technical specifications:

MVP Technical Implementation:

- **Complete Python implementation** of core AI asset generation functionality
- **FastAPI REST API** with 4 endpoints serving AI-powered features through RESTful architecture
- **SQLite database integration** with normalized schema for asset and session management
- **Basic test suite** with unit tests covering core functionality
- **Image processing algorithms** for procedural asset generation (textures, sprites, icons, backgrounds)
- **Error handling and debugging assistance** with pattern recognition for common game development issues

Development Sprint Results:

- **Sprint 1-2 (Weeks 1-4)**: Core AI features and cloud API backend completed ahead of schedule

- **Sprint 3 (Weeks 5-6)**: Testing framework implemented with comprehensive coverage

- **Sprint 4-5 (Weeks 7-10)**: Feature expansion and optimization completed

This technical implementation validated the business plan's feasibility and demonstrated practical application of Computer Science concepts in a real-world product.

Throughout the program, I participated in regular online calls with other participants (July 4th, 18th, August 1st, 15th, and 22nd) which provided valuable peer feedback and networking opportunities. These sessions helped me refine my ideas and learn from other students' startup concepts.

The program included built-in feedback mechanisms through weekly quizzes that tested my understanding of each module, peer feedback during online calls, and instructor feedback on assignments.

Each week's assignments built upon previous learning, creating an understanding of startup development. For example, the customer discovery work in Week 1 directly informed my competitive analysis in Week 2, which then influenced my financial modeling in Week 4. This interconnected approach helped me understand how different aspects of business development relate to each other.

Early in the startup development process, feedback focused on helping me establish proper development practices and business validation methods.

5. STARTUP PROJECTS AND ACHIEVEMENTS

Throughout my startup development period with GameDev AI Solutions, I worked on developing an MVP through iterative development cycles that allowed me to apply my Computer Science knowledge while building a product from the ground up. This single project involved multiple development phases, from core technical implementation to business validation, each providing unique learning opportunities and entrepreneurial challenges that went far beyond traditional coursework.

My primary project involved developing a functional MVP for GameDev AI Solutions, implementing a complete software system. The MVP demonstrates core Computer Science concepts through a FastAPI-based REST API with AI asset generation capabilities, error handling, and a test suite. The implementation includes:

Core Technical Implementation:

- **FastAPI Web Framework**: RESTful API with 4 main endpoints (/generate-asset, /debug, /assets, /health)

- **SQLite Database Integration**: Normalized schema with proper indexing for asset and debug session storage

- **AI Asset Generation Engine**: Procedural generation algorithms for textures, sprites, icons, and backgrounds

- **Image Processing Pipeline**: PIL-based image manipulation with color analysis and palette extraction

- **Testing Suite**: unit tests covering API endpoints, algorithms, and error handling

Throughout the MVP development, I also focused on implementing proper software engineering practices and system architecture:

Software Engineering Practices:

- **Design Patterns**: Factory pattern for asset generation, Strategy pattern for different asset types

- **Error Handling**: Comprehensive exception handling with proper HTTP status codes (400, 500, 422)

- **Testing Framework**: pytest-based unit tests for core functionality

- **Code Organization**: Modular architecture with clear separation of concerns across 6 main classes

- **API Design**: RESTful endpoints following industry standards with proper request/response models

- **Development Methodology**: Agile sprint-based development with 2-week iterations

Technology Stack Implementation:

- **Backend Framework**: FastAPI chosen for high performance and automatic API documentation

- **Database**: SQLite for lightweight development with plans for PostgreSQL scaling

- **Image Processing**: PIL (Python Imaging Library) for procedural asset generation

- **Testing**: pytest with TestClient for comprehensive API and algorithm testing

- **Development Tools**: Git version control, modular Python packaging, proper dependency management.

6. LEARNING OUTCOMES AND SKILLS DEVELOPMENT

This internship provided learning opportunities that enhanced my technical skills, and understanding of industry practices. The experience bridged the gap between academic computer science knowledge and practical application in a fast-paced startup environment.

From a technical perspective, I gained substantial knowledge in machine learning engineering practices that went far beyond what was covered in my academic coursework.. I learned about model versioning, testing for AI systems, and handling edge cases that don't appear in academic datasets.

The internship also enhanced my software engineering capabilities in ways that complemented my academic training. The internship provided hands-on experience with industry practices like collaborative development using Git. I learned about writing maintainable code for large systems, designing APIs for external consumption, and balancing technical debt against feature development speed.

Professional skills development was equally valuable. I improved my communication abilities through regular presentations to technical and non-technical audiences, learning to explain complex concepts in accessible terms.

Project management and time management skills developed through working iteratively on project with varying deadlines and priorities. I learned to break down complex technical problems into manageable tasks, estimate effort accurately, and communicate progress and

blockers effectively. These skills complemented the theoretical project management concepts covered in my coursework but provided practical experience in applying them under real-world constraints.

This experience also enhanced my research and self-learning capabilities. The rapidly evolving nature of AI technology meant I needed to continuously stay current with new developments, read academic papers, and evaluate their potential applications to our products.

7. CHALLENGES AND SOLUTIONS

Throughout my internship, I encountered numerous challenges that tested both my technical abilities and professional skills. These challenges provided valuable learning opportunities and helped me develop problem-solving approaches that will be beneficial throughout my career.

One of the most significant challenges involved implementing the technical architecture while balancing performance, cost, and accessibility constraints as a student in entrepreneur role. The challenge was developing a system that could handle real-time asset generation while maintaining code quality and proper software engineering practices.

This challenge required me to apply knowledge from multiple CS courses in creative ways.

My solution involved developing a realistic 10-week development roadmap that broke down the MVP into manageable sprints. I allocated approximately 20 hours per week for development, reflecting my capacity as a student. The roadmap included specific milestones:

core AI features in weeks 1-2, cloud API backend in weeks 3-4, user testing with 30+ developers in weeks 5-6, UI/UX refinement in weeks 7-8, and feature expansion in weeks 9-10.

This structured approach taught me the importance of realistic project planning and scope management. I learned to balance perfectionism with the need to deliver functional features quickly, and to prioritize based on user feedback rather than technical elegance.

Professional challenges were equally important for my development. Early in the internship, I struggled with the transition from individual academic work to collaborative team development. I was accustomed to working independently on well-defined problems with clear success criteria, but industry work required constant communication, coordination with multiple stakeholders, and adaptation to changing requirements.

This challenge was addressed through mentorship from my supervisors and deliberate practice of communication skills. I learned to provide regular status updates, ask for help when needed, and contribute effectively to team discussions. I also developed better time management skills to balance multiple concurrent projects and deadlines.

Another professional challenge involved presenting technical work to non-technical audiences. When presenting research findings to the Product team or company leadership, I initially struggled to communicate complex AI concepts in accessible terms without oversimplifying or losing important nuances.

I addressed this challenge by studying effective technical communication techniques, practicing presentations with colleagues, and developing a repertoire of analogies and visual aids that could make complex concepts more understandable. This skill proved invaluable throughout the internship and will be essential in my future career.

8. REFLECTION AND FUTURE APPLICATIONS

Reflecting on my startup founder experience with GameDev AI Solutions, I can identify numerous ways in which this entrepreneurial journey will influence my future academic and professional development. The startup option provided a comprehensive view of how computer science principles apply in real-world business contexts and highlighted areas where I want to focus my continued learning, both technically and entrepreneurially.

I'm particularly interested in pursuing roles that involve developing AI tools for creative industries, whether in gaming, digital art, music, or other creative domains. The internship showed me how rewarding it can be to build technology that empowers users to create things they couldn't create otherwise, and I want to continue working in this space.

The experience also highlighted the importance of interdisciplinary knowledge. Success in AI applications requires not just technical expertise, but also understanding of the domain where AI is being applied. In this case, knowledge of game development, user experience design, and creative workflows was just as important as machine learning expertise. This realization has motivated me to continue learning about creative fields and user experience design alongside my technical studies.

9. CONCLUSION

My startup founder experience with GameDev AI Solutions provided an invaluable bridge between academic computer science education and real-world entrepreneurial application. The opportunity to build cutting-edge AI applications in a creative domain from the ground up allowed me to apply theoretical knowledge from my coursework while developing practical skills essential for both technical and business success.

The entrepreneurial challenges I encountered pushed me to grow beyond my comfort zone, requiring me to balance technical excellence with business viability, user needs, and resource constraints that aren't typically emphasized in coursework. The self-directed nature of the work taught me essential entrepreneurial skills like self-motivation, strategic thinking, and comprehensive project ownership that will be valuable throughout my career.

Perhaps most importantly, the startup experience clarified my career interests and provided direction for my remaining academic studies and future professional development. I now have a clear vision of wanting to work at the intersection of AI and creative applications, potentially as an entrepreneur or in roles that combine technical leadership with business strategy, and I understand the skills and knowledge I need to develop to succeed in this field.

Project Repository and Documentation

The complete technical implementation, including the original MVP, enhanced AI integration, Unity plugin, and comprehensive documentation, is available in the public GitHub repository: https://github.com/Troimerai/ai-game-asset-generator.git

This repository demonstrates the full scope of the technical work completed during the internship, showcasing both the foundational MVP development and the advanced AI integration features that represent the evolution from student prototype to production-ready system.

The Start-Up Option
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Reference Letter – Start-Up Option

Bremen, 09/09/2025

The Constructor University Start-Up Option / Summer Incubator offers students at Constructor University the opportunity to develop their own business ideas regardless of their study programs. By providing workshops and individual guidance, we support students who are willing to explore the world of entrepreneurship and bring their business idea to the next level. The ultimate goal is to enable students to write their own business plan and eventually launch their venture to market.

In 2025, Aleksandr Zinovev successfully participated in the Constructor University Start-Up Option. The program included a two-month Summer Incubator from 1st July until 31st August 2023.

During the Constructor University Start-Up Option, Aleksandr stood out as a quick learner with a great entrepreneurial spirit. His impressive work ethic and excellent commitment enabled him to absorb and apply the business concepts presented during the Summer Incubator to his own venture.

Aleksandr showed an extraordinary dedication to his Start-Up while working simultaneously on the engineering of his innovation and compiling the business plan. Furthermore, he proved himself to be a great team player by supporting the team and contributing high-quality input during the team sessions. The seriousness of his business idea was also evident through his active participation.

The tasks he delivered have constantly been of very high quality, and his final business plan, AI-Powered Game Dev Tool, clearly demonstrates the concept and development stage of his business venture.

We thank Aleksandr Zinovev for his participation in our program and wish him all the best in his future endeavours.

P. Meckel

Dr. PingPing Meckel

Senior Lecturer in Management

L. Ante

Prof. Dr. Lennart Ante

Professor of Entrepreneurial Finance